When the whole drama had initially broken, Bouch phoned me to say that Hansie had also approached him and Jacques Kallis to take bribes to underperform, so he knew what was going on. Bouch didn't hold back. 'Hersch,' he implored, 'if you lie, you could go to jail.' And that's when I decided to come clean.

Right then I phoned Donné and Peter and told them to come to the Long Street Café … And I told them everything. I'm pretty sure that Donné knew all along that I was hiding something – I don't think there's anyone who knows me as well as she does. She took the news quite well, as she always does when I have to tell her about my latest indiscretion. She was just relieved that I was finally telling the truth. I'd had about two or three meetings with Peter before this as well and, following Hansie's instructions to keep denying everything, I had basically just lied in response to all his questions. I think Peter also knew that I wasn't being honest, and I felt pretty shit about it. I knew I had to be truthful, but I was being as plainly dishonest as one could get. Of course, in the back of my mind was also the knowledge that if I lied in front of the King Commission and was found out, I would probably be banned from cricket for life.

After my meeting with Donné and Peter, I phoned Hansie to let him know I would be telling the King Commission the full story. I would tell the commission how he had put the offer to me and Henry, and that we had initially accepted it, but that we had then changed our minds. I said I would also talk about the offer he had made to the whole team in 1996.

To his credit, Hansie wasn't angry or bitter. He simply said, 'Okay, fine. I understand.' I think that by this time Hansie had resigned himself to the fact that the only thing for him to do would be to tell the truth. Despite what he had done, I knew Hansie to be a very principled man. The guilt must have been eating away at him. In his testimony before the King Commission, Hansie admitted that he had received US$140 000 from Indian bookies, including the infamous MK Gupta, between 1996 and 2000. He denied, though, that he had conspired to fix any matches.

Once I had admitted the truth, Peter and I sat down to prepare for the commission. I felt a great sense of relief as I gave Pete all the details of what had happened. It was like a burden was being lifted off my shoulders. We must have got together three or four times before I was due to appear before the commission, and with Pete's help I felt confident that I could answer any questions Prosecutor Batohi would have for me.